From: Nicholas Scarr nscarr@quantlogic.com
Subject: Urgent Concerns: Secondary Damage, Rat Infestation, and Request for Immediate Approval of New Quotation – Policy with UK Insurance Ltd
Date: 27 May 2025 at 15:59:09
To: Sarah Romain sarah.romain@qlaims.com
Cc: Andy Lyne Andy.Lyne@qlaims.com, Louisa Scarr scarrlouisa@gmail.com

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Dear Sarah,

I am writing to express serious and escalating concerns about the continued handling of my insurance claim following the sewage flooding incident at my property. We are now three months on, and the absence of meaningful remedial action, combined with a lack of transparency and clarity on the part of the insurer, has resulted in substantial secondary damage and serious environmental risks.

I have copied in Andy Lyne from Qlaims, who, like myself, has found this process increasingly frustrating.

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1. Three Months of Inaction and Severe Deterioration

Tomorrow marks **three full months since the incident**, yet the property has seen **no effective remediation**. The claim took over two months to validate, and despite the severity of the sewage ingress, only a superficial clean was carried out early on. Since then, **sewage remains under the floorboards**, no drying has occurred, and the building has continued to deteriorate.

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2. Significant Secondary Damage and Health Hazards

As a result of this inaction, the property now suffers from:

- **Severe secondary damage** to both structural elements and contents
- **Deterioration of soft furnishings and materials throughout the entire house**
- **Likely airborne contamination**, affecting the upper floors
- Persistently **elevated humidity** and suspected **mold colonisation**
- An **infestation of rats**, which were attracted to the sewage and have now made conditions substantially worse

Although the property remains unoccupied, these environmental risks are a serious concern given our household's medical history — including my wife Louisa's near-fatal superbug infection and my own prolonged respiratory illness. These risks must be addressed as part of any remediation plan.

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3. Lack of Written Confirmation on Strip-Out Scope

Despite repeated discussions over several weeks, the **only written reference** from the insurer regarding plaster removal has stated **"up to 1 metre."** This wording is **insufficient and ambiguous**, particularly in light of the nature of the contamination.

I was informed that the **adjuster had verbally agreed to a minimum strip-out of 1 metre**, but this has **never been confirmed in writing**.

We now urgently require formal confirmation that **the plaster will be stripped to a minimum height of 1 metre throughout**, and higher where necessary based on damp readings or visible damage.

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4. Feedback from Busbys and Rejection of Inadequate Insurer Scope

We previously obtained a quotation from **Busbys**, a highly reputable local builder. Their **quantity surveyor assessed the property** and stated that the **damage was far more extensive than outlined in the insurer's surveyor's report**, which he also considered **incomplete**.

Busbys were highly critical of the insurer's proposed approach, particularly regarding the insufficient strip-out specification. They were not prepared to reduce their quotation due to the **necessary scope of work**, which we respected and understood.

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5. Submission of New Builder Quotation Today – Request for Immediate Approval

We have today submitted a **new quotation from a different reputable builder**, recommended by a local architect and able to **begin work immediately** due to a gap in his schedule.

- The builder's quotation reflects a **realistic and comprehensive scope**, consistent with the condition of the property

- They have confirmed they will **undertake plaster strip-out to a minimum height of 1 metre at no additional cost**

We are requesting that this quotation be **approved without further delay** to prevent any additional deterioration.

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6. No Access to Insurer's Contractor Quotation

To date, we have **not been given access to the full quotation** from the insurer's contractor. The summary document provided **does not reference plaster strip-out height**, nor does it contain sufficient detail to properly assess the specification.

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7. Request for Independent Hygiene Assessment of Upper Floor

We are also requesting that an **independent environmental hygiene firm** be instructed to inspect the **entire property**, including the upper floor. With confirmed **rodent infestation**, suspected **mold**, and probable **airborne contamination**, a full professional assessment is essential to determine the environmental health risks and define the appropriate remediation strategy.

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8. Summary

- The incident occurred **three months ago**, and the property remains contaminated and untreated
- There is now a **confirmed rat infestation**, compounding the health risks
- The quotation from **Busbys** was based on a comprehensive assessment and confirmed greater damage than the insurer's report acknowledged
- A **new builder's quotation** was submitted today, and the contractor can start immediately
- The builder has agreed to carry out **minimum 1 metre plaster strip-out at no extra cost**
- We have **not been given full access to the insurer's contractor quotation**
- The only written reference to strip-out height is **"up to 1 metre,"** which is inadequate
- We request an **independent hygiene inspection of the full property**

We would appreciate a prompt and comprehensive response confirming:

1. Approval of the **new builder's quotation**
2. Written confirmation that plaster will be stripped to a **minimum of 1 metre**, or more where necessary
3. Arrangements for an **independent hygiene inspection**

Yours sincerely,
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